

Main Idea & Details

Grade 3 Reading Comprehension Worksheet

Paragraph 1

Ants are tiny but mighty insects. They live in big groups called colonies. Each ant has a job. Some find food, and some guard the nest. Ants work together to carry heavy crumbs. Teamwork helps them survive.

1. What is the main idea of this paragraph?

- a. Ants are the smallest insects.
- b. Ants work together as a team to survive.
- c. Ants only eat crumbs.

2. Which detail supports the main idea?

Paragraph 2

The post office is a busy place. Mail trucks drop off bags of letters. Workers sort the mail into bins. Each bin goes to a different street. Carriers take the mail to houses. Every letter finds its way home.

3. What is the main idea of this paragraph?

- a. The post office sorts and delivers mail.
- b. Mail trucks are big.
- c. Letters are fun to write.

4. Which detail supports the main idea?

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Paragraph 1

Penguins cannot fly, but they are great swimmers. Their wings work like flippers. Their feathers keep them warm in icy water. Penguins dive deep to catch fish. They waddle on land but glide in the sea. Swimming is how penguins get their food.

1. What is the main idea of this paragraph?
 - a. Penguins live at the zoo.
 - b. Penguins like snow.
 - c. Penguins are built for swimming, not flying.

2. Which detail supports the main idea?

Paragraph 2

Making pizza is fun and easy. First, you spread the dough flat. Next, you spoon on red sauce. Then you sprinkle cheese on top. Last, you add your favorite toppings. After baking, the pizza is hot and melty.

3. What is the main idea of this paragraph?
 - a. Cheese is the best topping.
 - b. Pizza comes from Italy.
 - c. Pizza is made in simple steps.

4. Which detail supports the main idea?

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Paragraph 1

The desert is a dry, hot place. Very little rain falls there. Cacti store water in their thick stems. Camels can go days without a drink. Many animals hide during the hot day. They come out at cool night. Living things in the desert save water.

1. What is the main idea of this paragraph?
 - a. Camels are big animals.
 - b. Deserts are fun to visit.
 - c. Desert plants and animals save water to survive.

2. Which detail supports the main idea?

Paragraph 2

Firefighters help keep us safe. They put out fires in homes and forests. They rescue people from danger. They also teach fire safety at schools. Firefighters wear special suits and helmets. They train hard every day. They are brave helpers.

3. What is the main idea of this paragraph?
 - a. Firefighters like dogs.
 - b. Firefighters protect people in many ways.
 - c. Fire trucks are red.

4. Which detail supports the main idea?

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Paragraph 1

Whales are the largest animals on Earth. A blue whale can be as long as three buses. Whales breathe air through a blowhole. They swim in oceans all over the world. Some whales sing long, low songs. Whales are gentle giants of the sea.

1. What is the main idea of this paragraph?

- a. Whales eat fish.
- b. Whales are huge, gentle sea animals.
- c. Whales live in tanks.

2. Which detail supports the main idea?

Paragraph 2

The grocery store is full of choices. Fruits and vegetables sit in neat rows. The bakery smells like fresh bread. Milk and eggs stay cold in big cases. Shoppers push carts up and down the aisles. At the end, a cashier rings up each item.

3. What is the main idea of this paragraph?

- a. Bread is soft.
- b. A grocery store has many foods in sections.
- c. Grocery carts have wheels.

4. Which detail supports the main idea?

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Paragraph 1

Spiders spin silk to make webs. The silk comes out of their bodies. Webs are sticky traps for insects. A spider waits until a bug lands. Then it wraps the bug up for dinner. Webs are both homes and traps.

1. What is the main idea of this paragraph?

- a. Spiders have eight legs.
- b. Spiders are scary.
- c. Spiders use webs to catch food.

2. Which detail supports the main idea?

Paragraph 2

Thunderstorms can be loud and scary. Lightning is a giant spark in the sky. Thunder is the sound it makes. Rain pours down in sheets. It is safest to stay inside. Storms pass, and the sun comes back.

3. What is the main idea of this paragraph?

- a. Lightning is pretty.
- b. Rain helps plants.
- c. Thunderstorms are loud but they pass.

4. Which detail supports the main idea?

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Paragraph 1

Visiting the dentist keeps teeth healthy. The dentist counts your teeth. A helper cleans them with special tools. The chair tips back so you can rest. You get a new toothbrush at the end. Clean teeth make a bright smile.

1. What is the main idea of this paragraph?
 - a. Dentist visits keep teeth clean and healthy.
 - b. Teeth are white.
 - c. Dentists wear masks.

2. Which detail supports the main idea?

Paragraph 2

A garden needs sun, soil, and water. Seeds sprout into tiny plants. Roots drink water from the soil. Leaves catch sunlight to make food. Soon flowers bloom and vegetables grow. Gardens give us fresh food.

3. What is the main idea of this paragraph?
 - a. Gardens need care to grow food and flowers.
 - b. Gardens have fences.
 - c. Worms live in soil.

4. Which detail supports the main idea?

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Paragraph 1

The ocean is full of life. Tiny plankton drift in the water. Fish dart between coral reefs. Sea turtles glide slowly by. Sharks hunt for their meals. Every creature has a role. The ocean is a busy underwater city.

1. What is the main idea of this paragraph?
 - a. Many living things make the ocean their home.
 - b. Waves are big.
 - c. The ocean is salty.

2. Which detail supports the main idea?

Paragraph 2

Baking cookies is a sweet science. Butter and sugar get mixed first. Eggs and flour join the bowl next. Chocolate chips make them extra good. The oven bakes them golden brown. Warm cookies taste best with cold milk.

3. What is the main idea of this paragraph?
 - a. Milk comes from cows.
 - b. Cookies are made by mixing and baking ingredients.
 - c. Cookies are round.

4. Which detail supports the main idea?

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Paragraph 1

Dogs make loyal friends. They greet you with wagging tails. They learn tricks like sit and stay. Dogs can sniff out lost things. They love walks and belly rubs. A dog is happy just to be near you.

1. What is the main idea of this paragraph?

- a. Dogs need baths.
- b. Dogs are loyal and loving friends.
- c. Dogs bark loudly.

2. Which detail supports the main idea?

Paragraph 2

The moon changes shape each night. Sometimes it is a full circle. Sometimes it is a thin crescent. These shapes are called phases. The moon does not make its own light. It reflects light from the sun. Watching the moon change is fun.

3. What is the main idea of this paragraph?

- a. The moon goes through phases as it reflects sunlight.
- b. Stars twinkle.
- c. The moon is made of cheese.

4. Which detail supports the main idea?

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Paragraph 1

Recycling helps our planet. Paper, plastic, and glass can be reused. Sorting them into bins is the first step. Trucks take them to a recycling plant. There they are cleaned and made into new things. Recycling keeps trash out of landfills.

1. What is the main idea of this paragraph?
 - a. Bins are colorful.
 - b. Trucks are loud.
 - c. Recycling turns old materials into new things.

2. Which detail supports the main idea?

Paragraph 2

The zoo is home to animals from far away. Lions rest in the sun. Monkeys swing from ropes. Penguins splash in cold pools. Keepers feed each animal its favorite food. Signs teach visitors fun facts. A zoo trip is a day of discovery.

3. What is the main idea of this paragraph?
 - a. Zoos have gates.
 - b. Zoos care for animals and teach visitors.
 - c. Popcorn is sold at zoos.

4. Which detail supports the main idea?

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Paragraph 1

Snow is made of tiny ice crystals. Each snowflake has six arms. No two snowflakes look exactly alike. Snow falls when clouds get very cold. A blanket of snow keeps plants warm. Snow turns the world quiet and white.

1. What is the main idea of this paragraph?

- a. Snow is cold.
- b. Snow is made of unique ice crystals that blanket the earth.
- c. Kids like snow days.

2. Which detail supports the main idea?

Paragraph 2

The farmers market is busy on Saturdays. Farmers sell fresh fruits and vegetables. Bakers bring warm bread and pies. Flowers fill the air with sweet smells. Shoppers chat and taste samples. Buying local food helps nearby farms.

3. What is the main idea of this paragraph?

- a. Apples are red.
- b. Saturdays are fun.
- c. Farmers markets sell fresh local goods.

4. Which detail supports the main idea?
